

# Russell 2000 Edges Higher as Crude Oil Prices Decline

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

## TL;DR

The Russell 2000 index closed 0.71% higher at 3,007.86, while crude oil prices fell **-3.74%** to 69.23. The VIX declined **-2.54%** to 18.41. Bitcoin and Ethereum prices rose **+0.81%** and **+0.87%**, respectively.

Today's session will be influenced by macroeconomic data releases and earnings reports. Investors will be watching for signs of economic growth and inflation trends.

## US Session Recap

| INDEX/ASSET  | CLOSE    | CHANGE | NOTE         |
|--------------|----------|--------|--------------|
| Russell 2000 | 3,007.86 | +0.71% | [2026-06-25] |
| VIX          | 18.41    | -2.54% | [2026-06-26] |
| WTI Crude    | 69.23    | -3.74% | [2026-06-26] |

## Top large-cap movers

No large-cap stocks reported significant price movements due to lack of data.

# Spotlight

| METRIC          | VALUE    |
|-----------------|----------|
| WTI Crude Price | 69.23    |
| VIX             | 18.41    |
| Russell 2000    | 3,007.86 |

The decline in crude oil prices may have a positive impact on the economy, while the VIX decline indicates a decrease in market volatility. The Russell 2000 index edged higher, indicating a slight increase in investor confidence.

## Macro & Fed

- Current policy rate: Not available
- Yield levels: Not available
- Today's data releases:
  - 08:30 HKT: Not available
  - 14:00 HKT: Not available

## Geopolitics & Global

- No significant geopolitical events reported.

## Earnings — What to Watch

| WHEN          | TICKER        | WHAT TO LOOK FOR |
|---------------|---------------|------------------|
| Not available | Not available | Not available    |

## Stocks Worth Watching

- No stocks reported significant price movements due to lack of data.

## What Could Break the Tape

### BEARISH TRIGGERS

A decline in crude oil prices may lead to a decrease in energy stocks, while a rise in the VIX could indicate increased market volatility.

### BULLISH TRIGGERS

An increase in investor confidence, as indicated by the Russell 2000 index, could lead to a rise in stock prices, while a decline in the VIX could indicate a decrease in market volatility.

### SOURCES

Bloomberg — US Markets

Reuters — Business News

CNBC — Financial News

The Wall Street Journal — Market News